

A CANE'S LOOK

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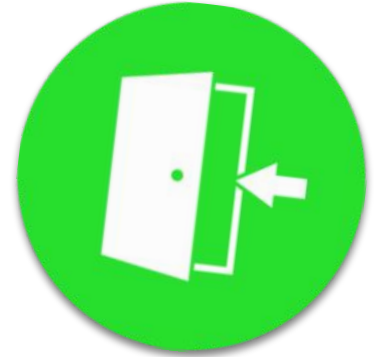
SCHOOL OF COMMUNICATION

GIVING YOU A SPIN AT THE U'S SAVVIEST SCHOOL.

**Jack Ketchum, Daniele Montefiori, Lejie Lin,
Alejandro Galego**

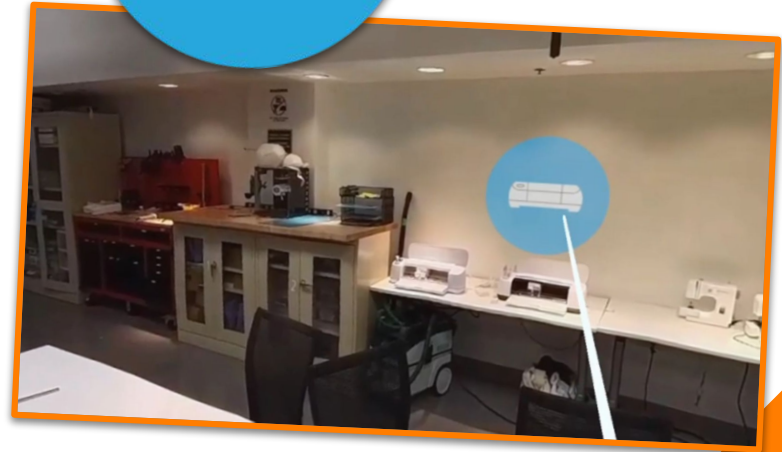
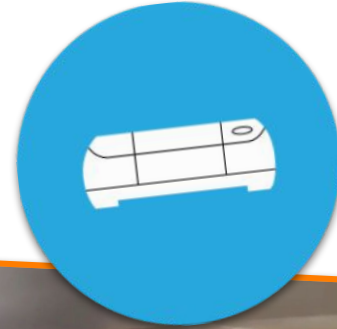
WHAT IS THE EXPERIENCE?

The experience is meant to be a virtual introductory tour of the School of Communication, taking users through different rooms and buildings in the school and educating them on their uses. A narrator will walk users through the experience, and after users explore everything in the school, they will be quizzed on their knowledge in a short quiz.



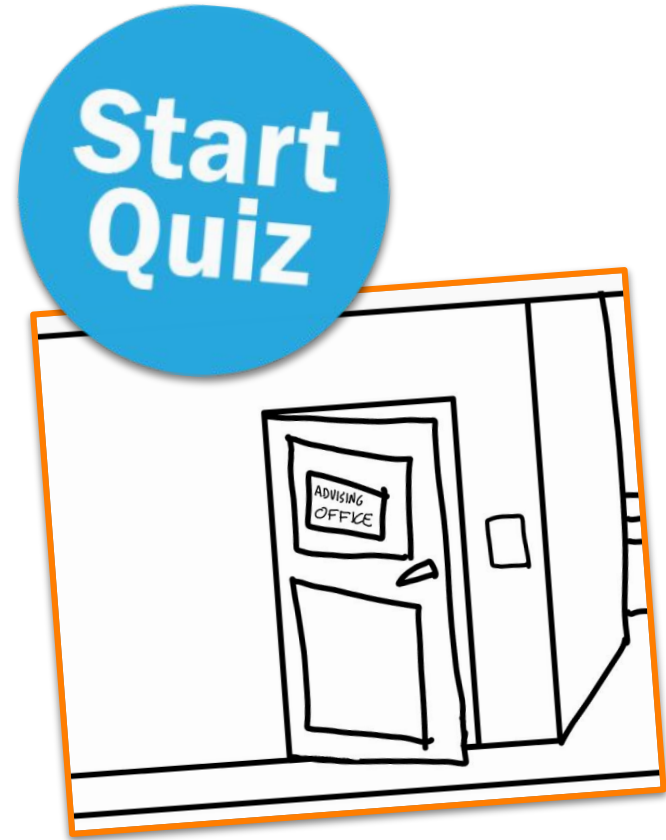
THE FUNCTIONS/APPEARANCE OF THE EXPERIENCE

- The experience is built around **360 videos recorded all around the School of Communication**, which is **wrapped around a sphere that surrounds the user**.
 - The user traverses through the experience by **clicking on buttons representing areas the player can go to or objects that they can interact with**.
- Throughout the experience, **a narrator** (presented as a senior student at the school) **guides the user throughout the experience**.
- At the end of the experience, the user is presented with a **quiz** of what they encountered before the experience concludes with the narrator departing for graduation and the user being left in front of the advising offices.



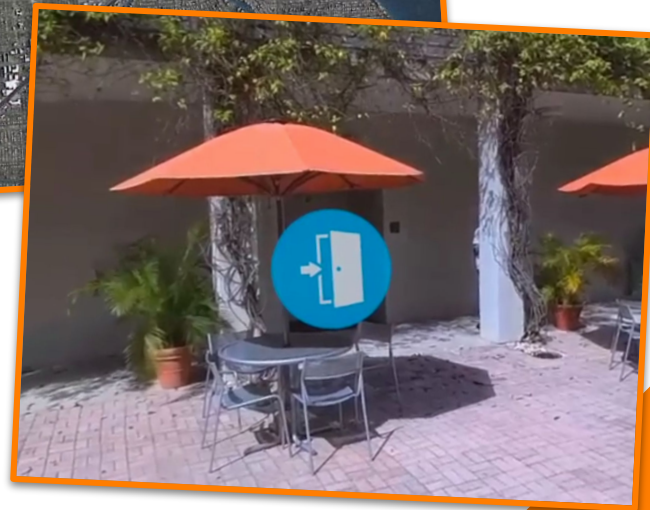
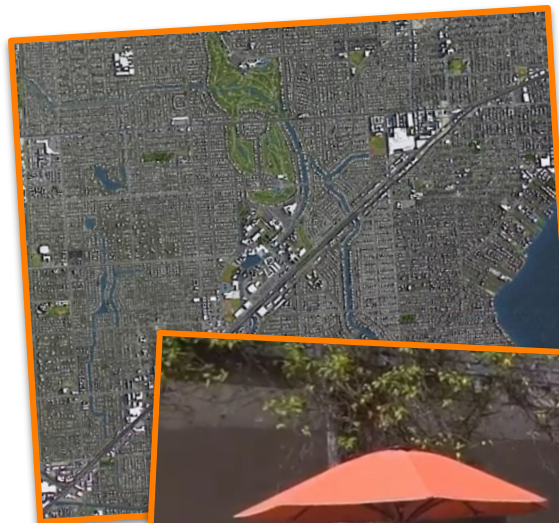
THE PURPOSE FOR THE EXPERIENCE

- **Incoming/Prospective students** seeking to enter the University of Miami via the School of Communication can only familiarize themselves with the school via **limited class descriptions and pictures** via the web and **may not be able to acquaint themselves with the actual physical environment of the school.**
- Through this **VR** experience, users will be exposed to an **immersive 360 tour of the School of Communication** that allows them to explore the various locations and buildings that make up the school in a more **visually engaging and informative manner** while also **providing a personable frame of reference** through a **sympathetic narrator character.**



THE PROGRESS & CHALLENGES DURING DEVELOPMENT

- Every weekend we convened virtually to check on our progress and plan out our next steps, working on the project in class during work days as well.
- Issues in regards to the size of the project preventing the build from being compiled correctly forced us to scale down the scope of the project.
 - Shift from both in-engine elements + 360 videos; to only videos.



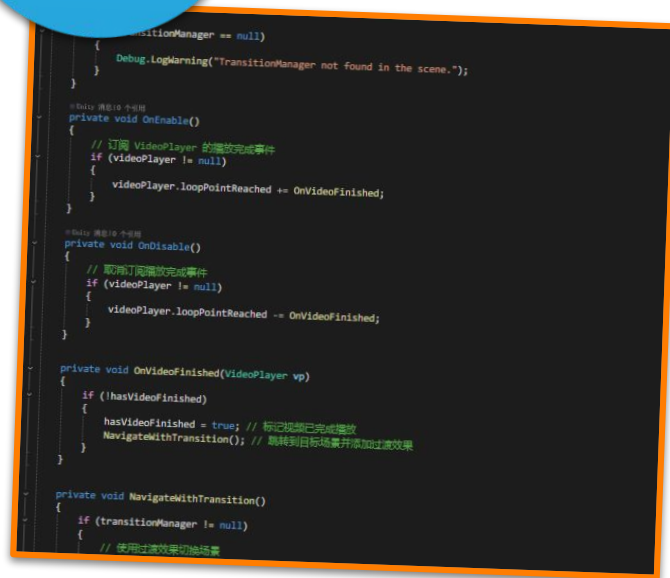
THE APPROACH TO RESOLUTION

Technical Improvements Made:

- Managed video sizes within APK limits while maintaining clarity.
- Implemented seamless scene transitions and navigation buttons.
- Balanced audio and video synchronization.
- Optimized UI and frame rates for smoother performance.
- Enhanced VR interaction with improved button highlights and pointer animations.

Collaborative Efforts:

- Streamlined workflow by addressing role conflicts and time constraints.
- Documented code for future scalability and ensured compatibility with both VR controllers and desktop devices.



ORIGINAL IDEA, CHALLENGES, TO THE FINAL PRODUCT

Original Idea:

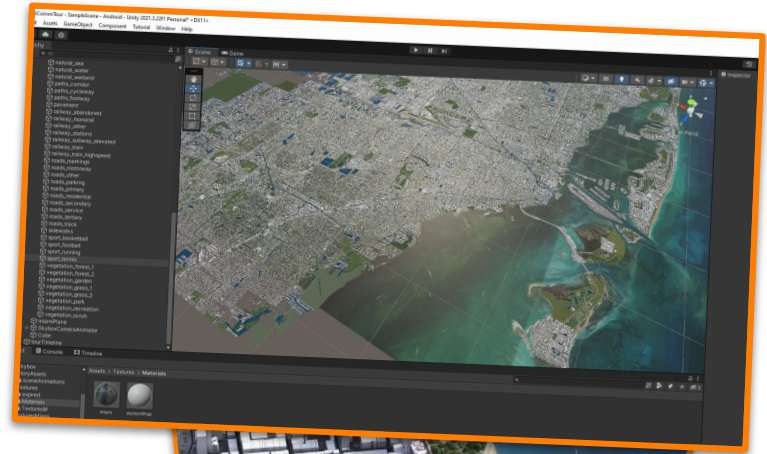
- The project aimed to integrate drone shots, 360 videos, and detailed 3D models to create a fully immersive VR tour of the university.

Challenges:

- High-quality 3D models caused significant lag in the VR headset and required disproportionate time for the intro sequence detracting from the overall experience.

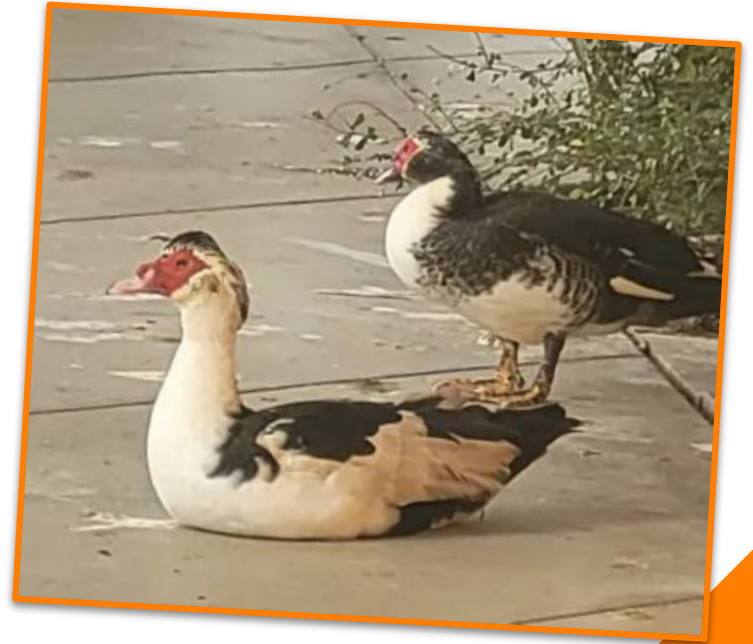
Final Product:

- The 3D models were replaced with optimized 360 videos for smoother performance. The final product maintained immersive storytelling with a captivating drone-shot introduction and seamless navigation.



PICTURES AND VIDEOS OF THE EXPERIENCE

<https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/0ALUAq0ITt-3-Uk9PVA>



PLANNING AND OUTLINE

Figma Map of Experience

<https://www.figma.com/board/Wt9x4Y8u1X1imDqkp593mD/CIM-458-Storyboard?node-id=118-1390>

Experience Planning Sheet

<https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/18Xcp-u-MWJC6mKAIbbv0anx0VX44MGFndc-RuzRxYss/edit?usp=sharing>

Timeline & Roles

https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1EcHH4Bm8TH_QTtx13FeIs5Y6hEAg6E_63VKarAKgB9Y/edit?usp=sharing